ADKAR Change Readiness

Find where people are in a change, spot the barrier point, and act on it before moving on.

Lead the Organisation · Inspired by Prosci's ADKAR® Model (Jeff Hiatt) · The People Side of Change

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

CHANGE: *Substitutes in stores*

SPONSOR: *Head of Store Ops*

1 Change on a Page

WHAT, WHY, WHO, WHEN

What's changing: *pickers choose substitutes for out-of-stock items*

Who's affected: *pickers in 12 stores, store managers, customer service*

Why now: *fewer second orders, and customers have asked for it*

Key dates: *pilot in one store from 2 June; all stores in July*

2 Readiness Grid

SCORE 1-5 · THE FIRST LOW SCORE IS THE BARRIER POINT

PERSON OR GROUP	A · AWARENESS	D · DESIRE	K · KNOWLEDGE	A · ABILITY	R · REINFORCEMENT	BARRIER POINT
Pickers, pilot store	1 2 3 **4** 5	1 2 **3** 4 5	1 **2** 3 4 5	**1** 2 3 4 5	**1** 2 3 4 5	*Desire*
Store managers	1 2 3 4 **5**	1 2 3 **4** 5	1 2 **3** 4 5	1 **2** 3 4 5	1 **2** 3 4 5	*Knowledge*
Customer service	1 2 **3** 4 5	1 2 **3** 4 5	1 **2** 3 4 5	1 **2** 3 4 5	**1** 2 3 4 5	*Awareness*
Basket team	1 2 3 4 **5**	1 2 3 4 **5**	1 2 3 **4** 5	1 2 **3** 4 5	1 **2** 3 4 5	*Ability*
Store Ops lead	1 2 3 4 **5**	1 **2** 3 4 5	1 2 **3** 4 5	1 2 **3** 4 5	1 **2** 3 4 5	*Desire*

Circle each score. Scores run 1 (not at all) to 5 (fully). The barrier point is the first element scored 3 or lower, working left to right. Fix it before working on later elements.

A · Awareness — *of why the change is needed*

MISSING IF…

People ask "why are we doing this?"
Rumours fill the silence

WHAT HELPS

- Sponsor explains the why, early and often
- Share the cost of not changing

Our action: *Priya explains the why at huddles*

D · Desire — *to support and take part*

MISSING IF…

People understand, but resist or stall
"What's in it for me?" is unanswered

WHAT HELPS

- Involve people in shaping the change
- Managers discuss concerns one-to-one

Our action: *pickers help design the screen*

K · Knowledge — *of how to change*

MISSING IF…

Willing, but unsure what to do
Lots of "how do I…?" questions

WHAT HELPS

- Training, guides and worked examples
- Show the new way on real work

Our action: *a one-page guide with examples*

A · Ability — *to do it in practice*

MISSING IF…

Know how, but can't do it yet
Old habits return under pressure

WHAT HELPS

- Coaching, pairing and practice time
- Remove blockers: tools, time, access

Our action: *practice runs before the pilot*

R · Reinforcement — *to make it stick*

MISSING IF…

Early wins, then people slide back
The old way is still rewarded

WHAT HELPS

- Recognise and celebrate adoption
- Measure use; fix what pulls people back

Our action: *share wins weekly with managers*

3 Action Plan

ONE ACTION PER BARRIER POINT

WHO (PERSON OR GROUP)	BARRIER POINT	ACTION	OWNER	BY WHEN
Customer service	*Awareness*	*a briefing on why, and what customers will see*	*Priya*	*23 May*
Pickers, pilot store	*Desire*	*two pickers co-design the substitute screen*	*Mei*	*30 May*

4 Reinforce & Re-assess

We'll recognise success by: *pickers suggest swaps without asking*

We'll measure adoption by: *% of missing items with a substitute*

Re-assess on: *4 weeks into the pilot*

"Where is each group in this change, really?"

"What's the first thing stopping them, and what would help most?"

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